

◆ MEN RULE 02 • OFFICE & WORK ETHICS – THE RULE BOOK

ANUPAM KUMAR • IN FORCE FROM AUGUST 24, 2026 • ONE PAGE • KEEP PRINTED

SHUT DOWN BY 9:00 PM – THE WALL • SIX VAULTS STAY SHUT • ZERO GOSSIP ORIGINATED
LEAD BEFORE THE TITLE • THE WORK SPEAKS, I STAY QUIET ABOUT IT

THE RULES

- 1 • THE SHUTDOWN – OFFLINE FIRST:** normal close 7:00 PM, laptop in the bag, zipped. A war-day (planned, rare) may run to **9:00 PM – THE WALL**. **Nothing crosses it – the capital price stands behind it.** **THE LAPTOP'S TERRITORY:** the office room, and nowhere else in the house – it enters no bedroom, no hall, no dining space; at 7:00 it goes into the bag, and the bag lives in the office room. The closing ritual every day: capture every open loop → plan tomorrow's blocks → say "Shutdown complete." A written plan releases the mind the way finishing does; the man who cannot stop is still clinging to the fruits. (*Newport • Gita 2.47*)
- 2 • THE SIX VAULTS – NOTHING PERSONAL, EVER:** ① money (salary • trading P&L • purchases) ② family frictions ③ health ④ plans (job moves, ventures – announce AFTER, never before) ⑤ relationships ⑥ my verdict on any absent person. Warm but private: I am the best LISTENER in the room – I ask, remember, follow up; my openness is cricket, food, training, craft. Deflect-and-return: "All good – how did your migration land?" **Never disclose self-doubt about my own competence at work** – a senior man who does loses status and influence (proven); doubts go to the journal or a mentor outside the chain.
- 3 • ZERO GOSSIP ORIGINATED:** I hear everything, I repeat nothing negative. About the absent I say one true good thing – "He's always been straight with me" – or the full stop: **"I'd rather not talk about someone who isn't here."** Feedback goes to the face, never around the back. The one who gossips TO me gossips ABOUT me – and everyone in the room knows it. Gossip originators are measurably rated less trustworthy, less likable, less expert.
- 4 • LEAD BEFORE THE TITLE (the 18-month campaign):** ownership language – banned: "they didn't tell me," "not my area," "I was waiting on..."; replacement: "That's on me – here's the fix." • My boss hears bad news from ME first, always with a recommendation attached • **Artifacts advertise:** design docs, post-mortems, the Friday one-page note – the work is seen without my saying "I did this"; accomplishments stated plainly or not at all (humblebrag tests worse than silence) • In every meeting: speak EARLY, under 60 seconds, WITH a position • Credit given away by name – "Priya's analysis cracked it" • I am the thermostat, not the thermometer • **ONE SPONSOR, two levels up:** deliver on something they own, ask their advice on hard problems quarterly (advice-seeking RAISES perceived competence), make my name easy to say in rooms I am not in • Glue work refused politely; mission-central scope taken instead • I teach juniors on the clock – from this seat, that IS the audition.
- 5 • THE 50-HOUR CAP + INTEGRITY ABSOLUTE:** output flatlines past ~50 sharp hours – the surplus goes to visibility, training people, and the missions; I never announce that I protect my time. Competence mistakes: confessed within 24 hours, fix attached – nearly free. **Integrity is unrecoverable capital:** one lie, one two-faced moment, defines me permanently. I say nothing behind a back I would not say to the face.

THE PRICE OF A BREACH

LAPTOP ALIVE PAST 9:00 PM – even by a minute **50 KM. WALK IT. AUTOMATIC.**

A VAULT OPENED • GOSSIP ORIGINATED
• LAPTOP IN ANY ROOM BUT THE OFFICE **10 KM. WALK IT.**

INTEGRITY SLIP – a lie, a two-faced moment **50 KM + APOLOGY TO THE FACE.**

PAID WITHIN 24 HOURS. NO EXTENSIONS. Rails: **food and sleep are NEVER the currency** – the machine is never punished, only the man's time • walks daylight only, never after 7 PM • flat, no compounding, subject to Rule 00's 50 km weekly ceiling • logged in pen on Sunday.

WHY – WHAT THE EVIDENCE ACTUALLY SAYS

Performance QUALIFIES me; sponsorship, conduct, and presence SELECT me – tenure by itself selects nobody. Hours past ~50 add zero output and burn the machine; endings set culture, and the man who cannot stop teaches everyone that presence is the metric.

One integrity failure is judged as a permanent trait; an owned mistake with a fix is nearly free. Gossip pays the originator in temporary belonging and charges him in permanent trust.

*And the oldest line under all of it: I have a right to my effort, never to its fruits. Full intensity till the wall – full release at it. **The work is the reward. Tomorrow's block is already scheduled.***

SIGNED: _____ DATE: _____

Deliver excellent work – then make it impossible not to notice, without ever saying so. 18 months. One sponsor. Zero gossip. The wall stands.